

Cranach, Grünewald and Holbein the Younger

The chief artist of the Reformation, Lucas Cranach the Elder (1472–1553) was the leading painter of Saxony, one of the most influential 16th-century German artists and a co-founder of the Danube School. Among his vast output, he produced altarpieces, portraits, hunting scenes and paintings of slender, elongated young women, both nude and fashionably dressed.

The colourful works of Matthias Grünewald (c.1475–1528) feature dazzling light effects. His current reputation is based mainly on his greatest masterpiece, *The Isenheim Altarpiece* (c.1514) filled with life, colour and tangible emotion. Although he was a Protestant, he also executed several commissions for the Catholic Church.

One of the most accomplished portraitists of the 16th century, painter and printmaker Hans Holbein the Younger (c.1497–1543) spent two spells in England, portraying figures at the Tudor court, often with numerous allegorical elements. Outstanding in capturing lifelike details, he also designed jewellery and metalwork.



Grünewald, *Isenheim Altarpiece*, 1512–6